Classification of Urban Settlement

Depending upon the functionality of the urban settlement, towns are classified as Administrative Towns, Commercial Towns, Cultural Towns, Recreational Towns, and Industrial Towns.

The settlements that established for the administrative purpose or having largely administrative function are known as **administrative towns.** For example, Washington D.C., New Delhi, Canberra, Paris, Beijing, Addis Ababa, and London etc.

The settlements that facilitate commercial opportunities are known as **trading and commercial towns.** For example, Agra, Lahore, Baghdad as an important transport node; Manchester and St Louis in land centers; Winnipeg and Kansas City as agricultural market towns; Frankfurt and Amsterdam as banking and financial centers; etc.





Recreational town, Volendum, Netherlands and Industrial town

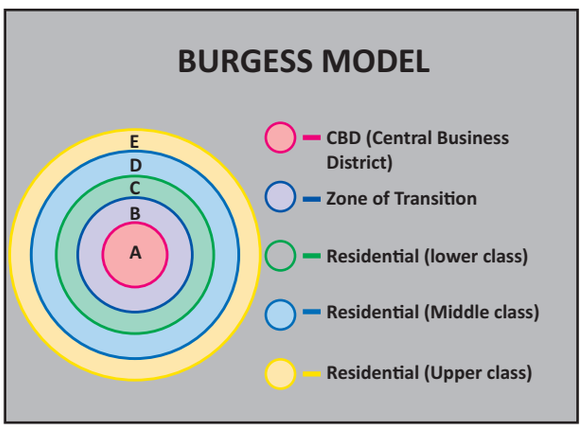
The settlements established because of religious adherence are known as **cultural or religious** towns. For example, Jerusalem, Mecca, Jagannath, Puri, Madurai and Varanasi, etc.

The settlements established for the recreational purpose are known as **recreational towns.** For example, Miami (U.S.A), Panaji (India), etc.

The settlements established because of industrial development are known as **industrial towns.** For example, Pittsburgh (U.S.A), Jamshedpur (India), etc.

2.7 The concentric zone theory

This theory was given by Ernest Burgess in 1925. He envisaged that the development of a city outwards from a centre in concentric zones in a ripple-like fashion. He made the following assumptions:



A. The city grows outwards in the form of five concentric zones or rings as long as there are no physical barriers, such as rivers or hills to distort the pattern.

B. The city has a single centre.

C. Growth is accomplished by a simple extension of each zone outwards into the next zone.

The characteristic features of each of the five zones can be described as follows.

Zone A: The central business district (C.B.D)

It is the heart of the urban community where the commercial, social and civic activities are concentrated. The heart of the C.B.D. or the downtown core has office buildings,

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